

Step 1: Simulate the Connectivity Issue

1. Ensure your printer is turned on.
2. **Unplug the USB cable** from either your computer or the back of the printer.
3. Open **Settings > Bluetooth & devices > Printers & scanners**. You will notice the printer's status change from "Ready" or "Idle" to "**Offline**" or "**Not connected.**"

Step 2: Identify the Problem in Device Manager

When a device is unplugged or experiencing a communication fault, Windows updates its hardware tree. Let's see how Device Manager reflects this:

1. Right-click the **Start Menu** button and select **Device Manager** (or press Win + X and select it).
2. Look through the categories. Depending on your printer driver, it will usually be listed under **Printers, Print queues**, or **Universal Serial Bus controllers**.
3. Because the cable is completely unplugged, the device entry will likely **disappear entirely** from the active list.

How to view disconnected devices: > In the Device Manager top menu, click **View** and check **Show hidden devices**. The printer will reappear, but its icon will look faded or translucent, indicating it is not physically connected.

Step 3: Resolve the Issue using "Scan for Hardware Changes"

Now, let's fix the connection and force Windows to re-initialize the printer.

1. **Reconnect the USB cable** securely back into the USB port.
2. If Windows doesn't register it immediately, you can manually force a refresh:
 - Click on your **computer's name** at the very top of the Device Manager list (this selects the root of your hardware tree).
 - In the top toolbar, click the **Scan for hardware changes** icon (it looks like a computer monitor with a small blue magnifying glass). Alternatively, click **Action** in the top menu and select **Scan for hardware changes**.
3. Windows will briefly flash/refresh the window as it rescans the USB ports.
4. The faded printer icon should now become solid, and any error icons (like a yellow exclamation mark $\triangle$ indicating a driver fault) should disappear.

Step 4: Verify the Resolution

1. Go back to your **printers & scanners** settings window.

2. Verify that the printer status has changed back to **"Ready"**.
3. Try sending a quick document or a test page to print; it should now process normally without getting stuck in the print queue.